



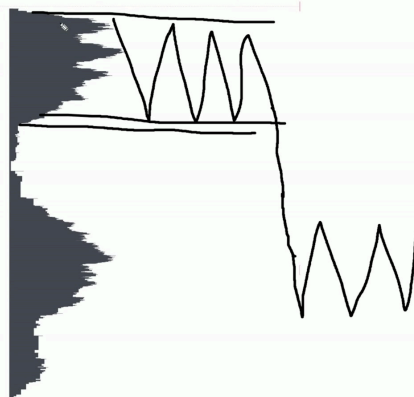
Reading The Volume Profile

The components, and the five shapes, that turn one indicator into a full thesis

SAINT ✕ ETHOS ORDER FLOW

Double Distribution

A Double Distribution Profile represents a market where both participants initially agreed on a certain price area and established fair value. Later, one side took control and drove price away from that area, eventually finding acceptance and establishing a new area of fair value.



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What the volume profile actually measures

why the bell curve is shaped the way it is

The volume profile is an indicator that measures volume within price, not volume over time the way a normal volume bar does. Plot it against a session where price played back and forth inside a range, and the shape that results is a bell curve, because the majority of the traded volume sits where price actually spent the most time.

That one relationship, more time at a price meaning more volume at that price, is what every other concept in this document is built from. It's used to determine areas of fair value, acceptance, rejection, support and resistance, high volume nodes, low volume nodes, and POC.

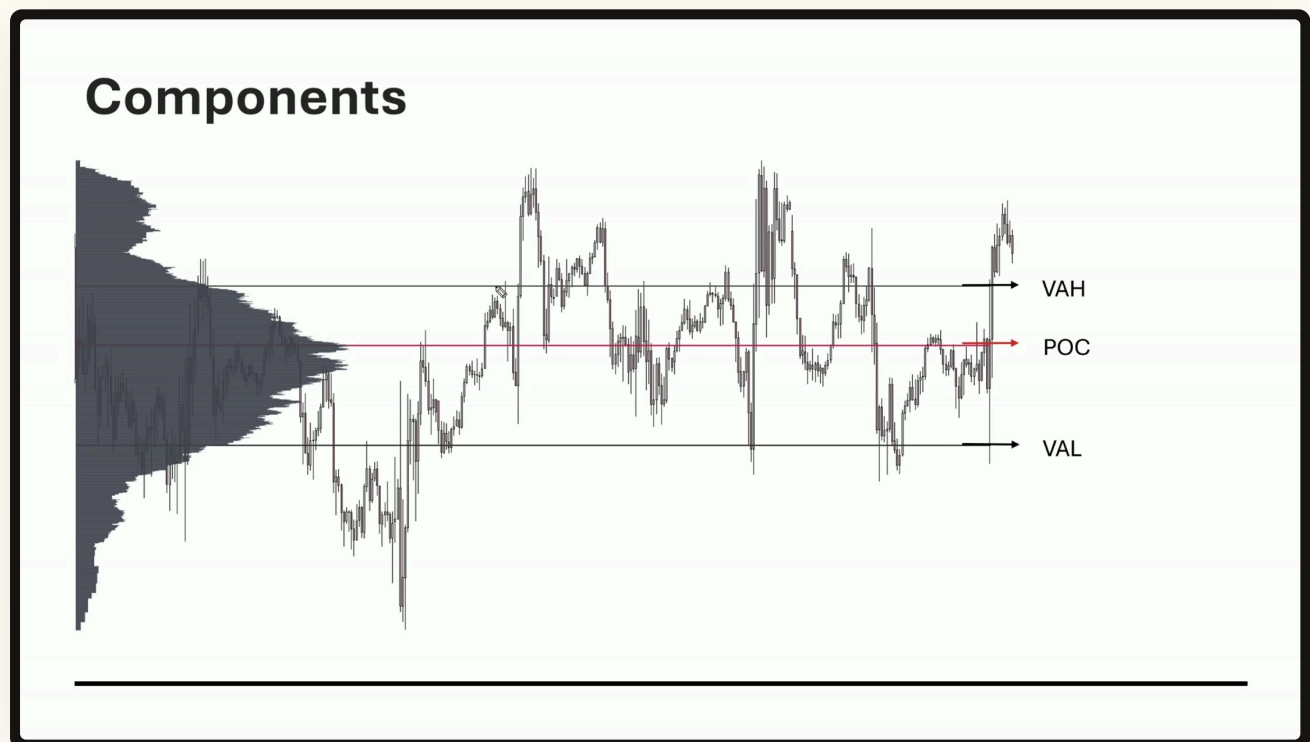
The three components: VAH, POC, VAL

value area high and low, and the point of control between them

Value area high is the highest price within the value area, the band where roughly 68 percent of the session's volume traded. Value area low is the same idea at the bottom of that band, the lowest price still inside that 68 percent. Between the two sits POC, the single price where the most volume of anywhere in the session traded.

These three levels are the raw material for everything that follows. Marked correctly, they tell you where the market has already agreed to do business, which is a very different, much more concrete question than where you think price might go next.

VAH, POC AND VAL MARKED ON A REAL SESSION



POC as a magnet

why price keeps returning to it, and how to read a target from it

His description of POC is direct: it's a magnet within the balance. Price comes back to it regardless of which direction it approaches from. Once that's the working assumption, the read becomes about which further level price is likely to reach, not whether it returns to POC at all.

If price fails to break above POC, retesting it again and again without holding above, the more likely outcome is a full trip back down to value area low. If instead price retests aggressively and then pushes through POC with real aggression, value area high becomes the more likely target. The behavior around POC, not a guess about direction, is what separates the two reads.

Continuation vs reversal

why he trades one far more than the other

A continuation, in his framing, is price breaking out of the range, coming back into it for a retest, and then continuing in the direction of the original break. A reversal is price moving up into the range and simply turning the other way once inside it.

His own preference is stated plainly: he trades continuations, and rarely trades reversals, because continuations give him a higher win rate. That's a personal statistic, not a claim about which read is theoretically correct, and it's worth carrying into every shape covered from here on, since most of them are read the same way, for a break and a retest, not a turn.

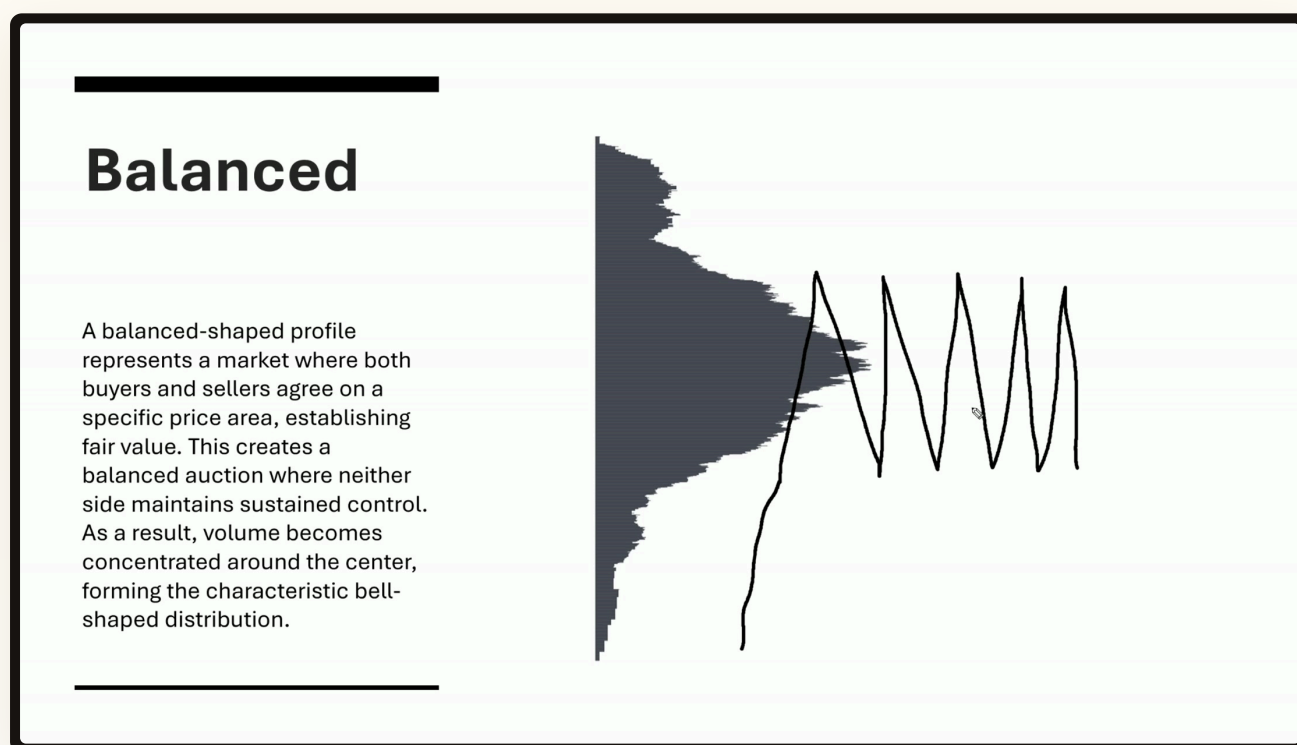
07 The balanced profile

when neither side controls, and why these levels are the strongest

A balanced profile is where both buyers and sellers agree on a specific price area, establishing fair value with neither side in overall control. Price plays end to end inside the range, sellers more dominant near the top, buyers more dominant near the bottom, neither strong enough to break the range outright.

His recommendation is specific: levels built from a balanced profile are the strongest and most easily identifiable in the market, and they're the ones he prefers to build a plan around. The bell curve shape is the visual signature, volume concentrated in the middle, tapering evenly at both extremes.

THE BALANCED PROFILE: PRICE PLAYING END TO END, NEITHER SIDE IN CONTROL



The double distribution

his favorite structure for building context, with a full trade example

A double distribution is where both sides initially agree on a price and establish fair value, then one side takes control and drives price away into a fresh imbalance, before both sides come back into agreement at a new price and build a second area of fair value. The result is two distinct shelves on the profile, one above, one below, joined by the leg that connects them.

This is one of his favorite structures for building context specifically because it gives you a plan before price ever gets there. With two shelves marked, if price opens and comes down to retest the lower shelf and buyers hold it, the read is a long back toward the upper extreme, entry at the retest, target at the far shelf. If price opens lower instead and sellers break through with a retest that holds, the same logic runs in reverse: short the retest, target the next extreme down.

TWO SHELVES, ONE LEG: THE RETEST MARKED, ENTRY AND TARGET SET IN ADVANCE

Double Distribution

A Double Distribution Profile represents a market where both participants initially agreed on a certain price area and established fair value. Later, one side took control and drove price away from that area, eventually finding acceptance and establishing a new area of fair value.

Building context from a double distribution before the session opens is walked through live inside the mentorship.

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The trending profile

when to do nothing, and the mistake that blows accounts

A trending profile is what happens when one side maintains control for the entire session, continuously driving price in one direction while the other side never gains enough footing to establish a balanced area of fair value. The result is a directional auction with little acceptance anywhere along the way, and on the profile itself, a shape with no real bell curve, just a long, narrow spread of volume.

His instruction for this shape is the whole point of including it: when you see one, get off. There's nothing to trade. He names the specific mistake beginners make against it directly: seeing a strong trend and repeatedly trying to long a small reaction inside it, again and again, taken out each time, until the account is gone. A trending profile isn't a setup, it's a signal to stop looking for one.

THE TRENDING PROFILE: ONE SIDE IN CONTROL ALL SESSION, NO FAIR VALUE ESTABLISHED



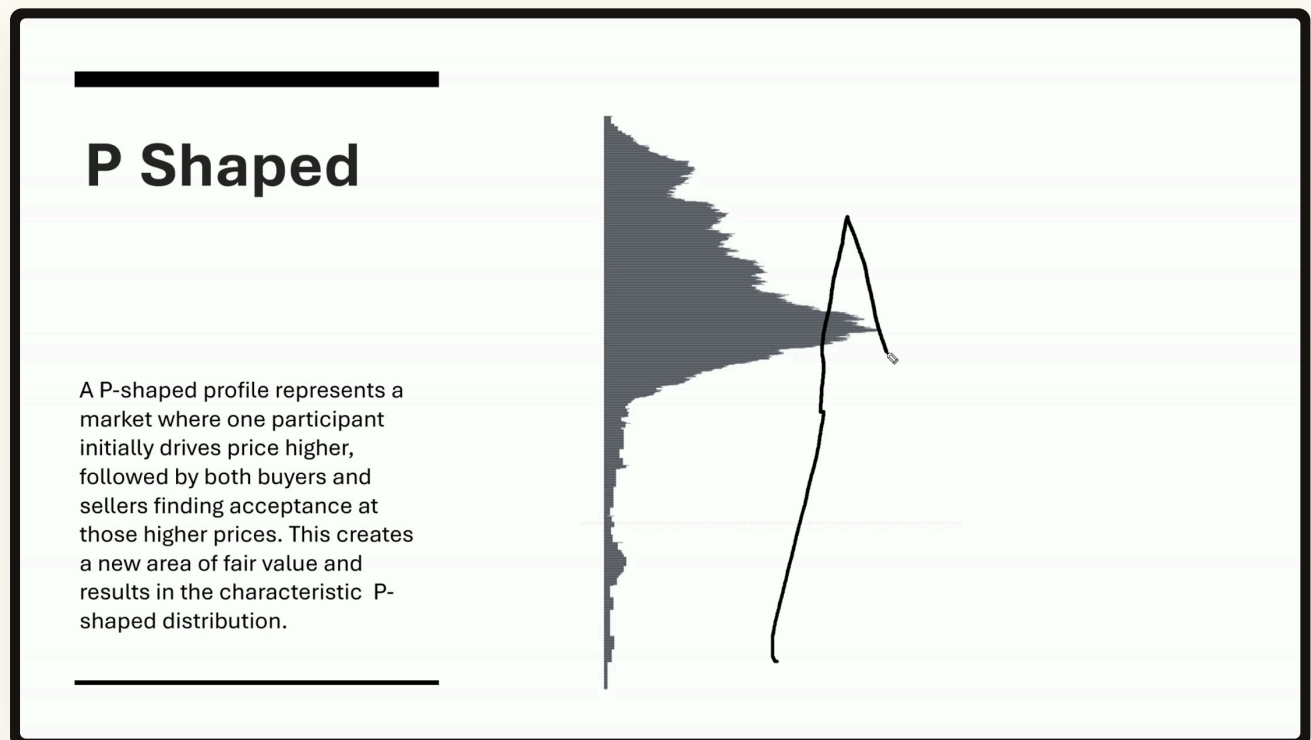
The P-shaped profile

one side drives, then both agree, at the top

A P-shaped profile forms when one side, typically buyers, initially drives price higher, and is then followed by both sides finding agreement at that higher price, building a new area of fair value there. On the profile itself this leaves a thin stem below and a wide bulge of volume at the top, the letter it's named for.

Once that upper fair value is established, the read is the same continuation logic from earlier in the document: don't chase the trend that built the shape, wait for the range at the top to resolve. If buyers are dominant inside it and price breaks out with a retest that holds, that's the long, continuing the move the shape was already built on.

THE P-SHAPED PROFILE: A DRIVE HIGHER, THEN AGREEMENT AT THE TOP



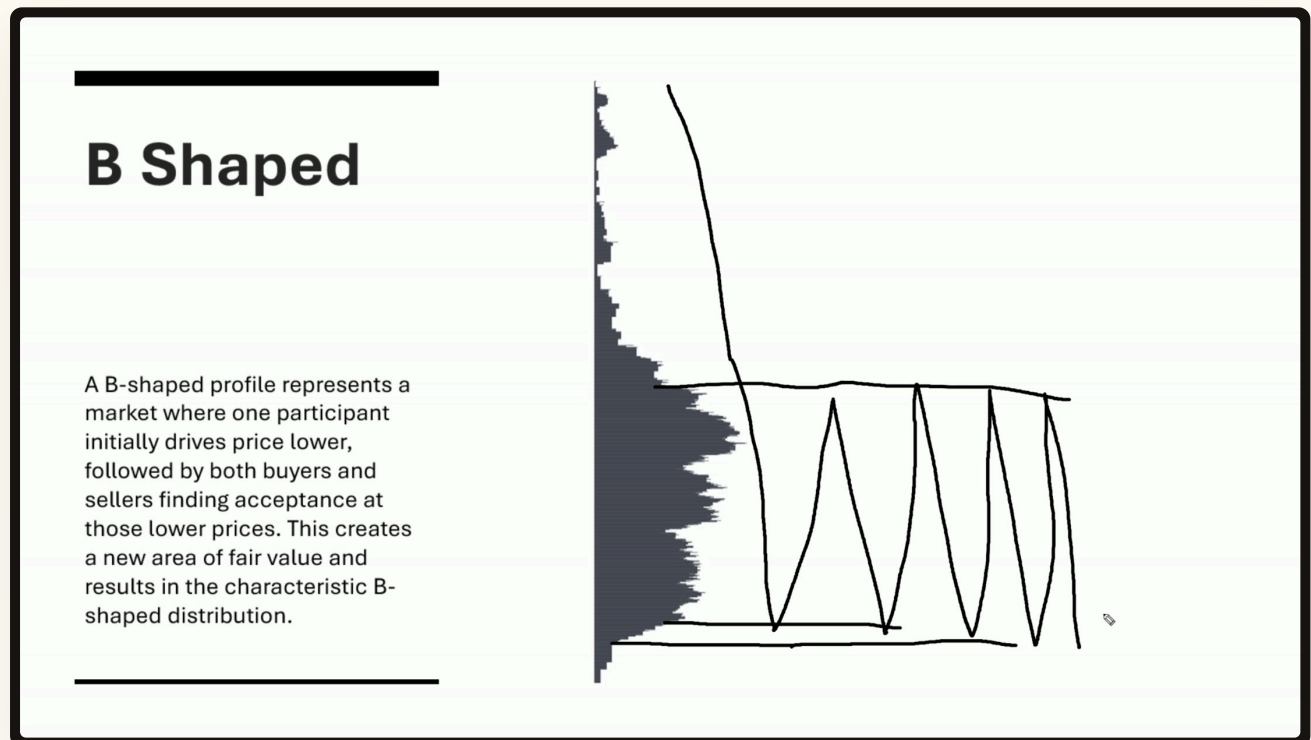
The B-shaped profile

the same idea, mirrored to the downside

A B-shaped profile is the exact same mechanism as the P-shape, run in the other direction: one side, this time sellers, drives price lower first, and both sides then come into agreement at that lower price, building fair value there. The profile shows a wide bulge of volume at the bottom and a thin stem above it.

Read it the same way as the P-shape, mirrored: don't fight the drive that built it, read the range once fair value is established, and with a B-shaped profile the underlying trend is lower, the same way a P-shape says the underlying trend is higher.

THE B-SHAPED PROFILE: THE MIRROR OF THE P-SHAPE, TREND READ AS LOWER



The checklist

every rule in this document, printable

THE COMPONENTS

- ☐ I've marked VAH, POC and VAL before forming any opinion about direction.
- ☐ I'm reading POC behavior (repeated failure vs. an aggressive break) to decide between the VAL and VAH targets.

CONTINUATION OVER REVERSAL

- ☐ I have a break AND a retest that held, not just a level being touched.

READING THE SHAPE BEFORE THE SESSION

- ☐ I know whether I'm looking at a balanced, double distribution, trending, P-shaped or B-shaped profile.
- ☐ If it's trending, I've accepted there's nothing to trade rather than fighting it.
- ☐ If it's a double distribution, I have both shelves marked and a plan for either direction before price gets there.

One profile. Five shapes to read it in.

Nothing in this document is a promise about what a trial gets you specifically. It's the theory half of a two part series, the components, the shapes, and the logic behind each one, before a single live example is shown. Part two covers how these get used on real charts.

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Live sessions, daily, where this framework gets applied to the actual open.

Companion reading: AMT On Live Markets, and Who's In Control, both free at kanji.org.uk.

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